

Manual Chain Hoist

Technical Datasheet - Mechanical Theatre Equipment Compliance Portal

LOLER | PUWER | BS EN 17206 | ABTT Technical Standards

1. Document control

Field	Entry	Field	Entry
Document title	Manual Chain Hoist Technical Datasheet	Document ref	MCH-TDS-001
Version	Draft 1.0	Date	To be completed
Prepared by	To be completed	Reviewed by	To be completed
Status	Template / guidance document	Next review	To be completed

2. Equipment overview

- A manual chain hoist is a hand-operated lifting appliance used to raise, lower or suspend loads in controlled theatre, entertainment, workshop or installation environments.
- The hoist relies on a load chain, hand chain, gearing, brake, top hook and bottom hook to control the load safely.
- The manual chain hoist, its suspension point, hooks, shackles, slings and supporting structure should be assessed as one complete lifting arrangement.
- This datasheet is a generic template and must be completed or amended using the specific manufacturer instructions, rating plate, inspection report and site conditions.

3. Typical applications

- Raising, lowering or positioning loads during installation, maintenance or controlled rigging work.
- Temporary suspension or controlled movement of theatre equipment where the hoist is suitable for the load and environment.
- Use with approved rigging points, beam clamps, trolleys, truss arrangements or supporting structures as part of a competent-person assessed lift plan.
- Use only within the stated rated capacity / WLL / SWL and manufacturer instructions.

4. Key components

Component	Inspection relevance
Top hook / suspension fitting	Connection to the support point; check seating, wear, distortion and latch condition where fitted.
Bottom hook / load hook	Connection to the load or accessory; check deformation, wear, cracks and safety catch.
Load chain	Primary load-bearing element; check links for

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	wear, elongation, twisting, damage, corrosion and contamination.
Hand chain	Operator input; check free movement, seating, damage and correct operation.
Brake and gearing	Controls and holds the load; check holding function, smooth operation and signs of slipping.
Hoist body / casing	Protects mechanism; check cracks, missing covers, impact damage, loose fixings and contamination.
Identification and rating plate	Confirms capacity and identity; must be legible and linked to records where required.

5. Technical data to be completed

Item	Value	Item	Value
Manufacturer	To be completed	Model / type	To be completed
Serial number	To be completed	Asset ID	To be completed
Rated capacity / WLL / SWL	To be completed	Chain falls	To be completed
Lift height	To be completed	Chain size / grade	To be completed
Suspension type	Top hook / trolley / other	Duty / use category	To be completed
Location / venue	To be completed	Installed / portable	To be completed
Last thorough examination	To be completed	Next due date	To be completed

6. Compliance and guidance context

Source	Status	Relevance to manual chain hoist
LOLER 1998	UK regulation	Applies where the hoist is lifting equipment used at work. Relevant to strength, stability, marking, planning, thorough examination and competent-person inspection.
PUWER 1998	UK regulation	Applies as work equipment. Relevant to suitability, maintenance, inspection, information, instruction, training and safe use.
BS EN 17206	Standard	Relevant where the hoist forms part of entertainment machinery or an installed stage/production lifting arrangement.
ABTT Technical Standards	Industry guidance / good practice	Supports recognised theatre-industry good practice for installation, inspection, maintenance, operation and management in places of entertainment.

7. Recommended inspection approach

- Pre-use inspection: basic user check before use for obvious damage, missing markings, abnormal operation, chain damage, hook damage or other defects.
- Interim inspection: risk-based inspection between thorough examinations where use, environment or site conditions may cause deterioration before the next formal examination.

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- Thorough examination: formal competent-person examination, normally producing a written report and confirming fitness for continued use or identifying defects/actions.
- Default thorough examination interval for lifting equipment not used for lifting persons is generally 12 months, unless an examination scheme specifies otherwise. Accessories used with the hoist may require shorter intervals depending on their classification and use.
- Examine sooner after exceptional circumstances such as overload, impact, suspected damage, significant repair, modification or long periods out of use.

8. Inspection checklist

Area	What to check	Result / notes
Identification	Asset ID, rating plate, WLL/SWL, serial number and inspection label are present and legible.	
Top hook / suspension	Correctly seated; no distortion, cracks, excessive wear, corrosion or damaged latch.	
Bottom hook / load hook	No opening out, twisting, cracks, wear or latch damage; hook rotates/swivels as intended.	
Load chain	No twisting, worn links, elongation, cracks, corrosion, contamination or damaged welds.	
Hand chain	No damage or poor seating; moves freely and operates the mechanism smoothly.	
Brake / holding function	Hoist holds the load without slipping, creep or uncontrolled movement.	
Hoist body	No cracked casing, missing covers, loose bolts, impact damage or abnormal contamination.	
Operation	Lift/lower action is smooth without jumping, grinding, snatching or abnormal noise.	
Accessories and support	Suspension point, shackles, slings, beam clamp or trolley are suitable, rated and correctly fitted.	
Records	Thorough examination report, maintenance record and defect actions are available and current.	

9. Common defects and withdrawal criteria

- Missing, illegible or uncertain WLL/SWL/rated-capacity marking.
- Unknown identity, missing asset number or missing inspection history where required by site procedure.
- Load chain wear, twisting, elongation, corrosion, damaged links, cracked welds or contamination affecting safe use.
- Hook distortion, latch failure, cracks, excessive throat opening, wear at bearing points or incorrect seating.
- Brake slip, failure to hold, uncontrolled lowering, jumping, grinding or abnormal noise during operation.
- Damaged casing, missing covers, loose fixings, poor suspension arrangement or signs of impact/overload.
- Incorrect, damaged, unrated or incompatible accessories used with the hoist.
- Any doubt about rating, condition, compatibility, installation or inspection status.

10. Operational safety notes

1. Confirm the load weight and centre of gravity before lifting.
2. Check that the hoist, suspension point and all accessories are rated for the load and load path.
3. Never exceed the rated capacity of the hoist or accessories.
4. Do not use the load chain as a sling around the load unless the manufacturer specifically permits this.
5. Keep the load line vertical unless the equipment and lifting plan specifically allow otherwise.
6. Do not stand or allow others to stand under suspended loads.
7. Make a small trial lift to confirm balance, brake holding and stability before continuing.
8. Use clear communication and stop the operation if abnormal movement, noise or resistance is observed.
9. Remove the hoist from service and refer to a competent person if defects or uncertainty are identified.
10. Store the hoist dry and protected from damage, contamination and corrosion after use.

11. Records and supporting documents

Document / record	Status / location
Manufacturer operating instructions	To be completed
Declaration/certificate supplied with equipment	To be completed
Latest thorough examination report	To be completed
Maintenance records	To be completed
Defect reports and corrective actions	To be completed
Site risk assessment / lifting plan	To be completed
Training / competence records	To be completed

12. References and source context

- HSE - Lifting Operations and Lifting Equipment Regulations 1998 (LOLER) guidance, including thorough examination of lifting equipment.

- HSE - Provision and Use of Work Equipment Regulations 1998 (PUWER) guidance, including suitability, maintenance, inspection, training and competence.
- BS EN 17206 - Entertainment technology - Machinery for stages and other production areas, where applicable to installed entertainment machinery systems.
- ABTT Technical Standards - industry guidance / good practice for places of entertainment.
- Manufacturer instructions, site rules and competent-person assessment must take precedence over this generic template where more specific requirements apply.

13. Portal document link block

Use this block inside the manual_chain_hoist equipment item if uploading the PDF to the portal documents folder:

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documents: [  
  {  
    title: "Manual Chain Hoist Technical Datasheet",  
    file: "documents/manual_chain_hoist_technical_datasheet.pdf"  
  }  
]
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Important note

This document is a generic technical datasheet template. It does not replace manufacturer instructions, site-specific risk assessment, a lift plan, a written scheme of examination, or competent-person judgement.